

Total Marks = 12.5

PART A

1. Lily, a 34-year-old graphic designer, has not left her house in the past 9 months. She avoids malls, buses, or even the park near her home. When she contemplates going outside, her heart races, her palms sweat, and she feels like she's going to faint. She insists on having groceries delivered and refuses to even open the door unless it's absolutely necessary. In therapy, she revealed that these symptoms started after she had a panic attack at a shopping centre.

- a) Based on the given symptoms, would you classify Lily as having a mental disorder? Justify your answer using at least three core criteria. **(3 marks)**
- b) What disorder does this presentation most closely align with? **(1 mark)**
- c) In order to diagnose any fear as phobia, what is the criteria? **(1 mark)**

- 1) a) Yes. According to the symptoms, Lily meets the criteria for a mental disorder because her symptoms lead to subjective distress, impairment in daily functioning, and involve biological dysfunction (heightened anxiety, panic symptoms) (1 mark for each criteria) (any two criteria of the five criteria)

b) Agoraphobia

c) For a fear to be diagnosed as a phobia, it must restrict our life, create considerable distress, or do both.

2. Ryan, a 29-year-old man, is brought to a psychiatric evaluation by his family. He insists that government satellites are monitoring his brain activity and transmitting his thoughts to a secret agency. He also claims he can hear two distinct voices: one praises him for uncovering the truth, while the other threatens to punish him for speaking out. He sometimes reports smelling burning rubber when no one else notices anything unusual and refuses to eat because he believes his food is poisoned, despite no evidence.

- a) Based on this case, identify what kind of delusion and hallucination Ryan is experiencing? **(1.5 marks)**
- b) Based on the above case, highlight the key differences between delusions and hallucinations. **(2 marks)**

Ans

a) Ryan's belief that government satellites are monitoring his brain is a delusion of persecution. Ryan's experience of hearing voices or smelling burning rubber is an example of auditory and olfactory hallucinations, respectively

b) DELUSIONS: FIXED FALSE BELIEFS. Among the hallmark symptoms of schizophrenia are delusions—strongly held fixed beliefs that have no basis in reality. Delusions are called psychotic symptoms because they represent a serious distortion of reality. HALLUCINATIONS: FALSE PERCEPTIONS.

Among the other serious symptoms of schizophrenia are hallucinations: sensory perceptions that occur in the absence of an external stimulus.

3. Which disorder is marked by instability in mood, identity and impulse control? What are the specific symptoms of this disorder? **(1+3 marks)**

Ans) Borderline Personality Disorder, (1 mark),

Fear of abandonment, Extreme Mood Swings, Unstable Relationships, Unstable Self Image, Self-Harm, Paranoia, Dissociation, Chronic Feeling of emptiness, (Any 6, 0.5 marks each)